

ENGLISH LANGUAGE

LEVEL A1

Build confidence and act in immediate everyday situations

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CEFR-Based English Language Curriculum Designer

Curriculum structure • authentic tasks • projects • differentiation • assessment • portfolio

From first words to simple independent exchanges

Framework note: proficiency progression is grounded in the CEFR-level document supplied by the user. English-specific grammar, phonology, lexical sequencing and tasks are a pedagogical adaptation created for English.

Pedagogical vision - Level A1

A highly scaffolded, action-oriented start focused on intelligibility, useful chunks and immediate communication.

1. Exit profile

By the end of A1, the learner can understand and use familiar everyday expressions, identify key information in short messages and instructions, introduce themselves and others, ask and answer basic personal questions, describe familiar people and places, and take part in very simple exchanges when speech is clear and cooperative.

2. Core competence targets

- **Listening/Reading:** identify familiar words, numbers, names, times, places, instructions, notices and the main point of very short messages.
- **Speaking:** introduce oneself, describe family/routines/places, ask simple questions, make basic requests and handle predictable service encounters.
- **Writing:** complete forms and write short notes, descriptions, invitations, messages and simple personal profiles.
- **Interaction/Mediation:** ask for repetition, clarify a basic need, relay a time/place/price and use memorised expressions politely.
- **Language control:** build reliable control of high-frequency grammar, sentence patterns and pronunciation features needed for intelligibility.

3. Annual progression map

Unit	Theme	Main communicative goal	Signature performance
1	Hello! This Is Me	Introduce yourself and exchange basic personal information.	Create and present a personal English profile card.
2	Family, Friends and People	Talk about family, appearance, personality and possessions.	Present a real or imaginary family/friend gallery.
3	My Day and My School	Describe daily routines and school life.	Create a "day in my life" timeline or audio diary.
4	Home, Town and Directions	Describe a home/town and ask for or give basic directions.	Design a mini-town and guide a visitor.
5	Food, Shopping and Free Time	Order food, shop for basic items and discuss hobbies.	Run a class mini-market or café in English.
6	Weather, Plans and My English World	Talk about weather, immediate plans and simple past experiences.	Complete the A1 "English-Speaking World Passport".

4. Pedagogical principles

- **Action-oriented learning:** every language focus is linked to a communicative purpose and a visible performance.
- **Integrated skills:** listening, reading, spoken interaction, spoken production, writing and mediation are combined rather than taught in isolation.
- **Spiral progression:** key structures and lexical fields reappear with greater complexity and independence.
- **Pronunciation for intelligibility:** accuracy is developed through rhythm, stress, connected speech and high-value contrasts, without requiring imitation of one single native accent.
- **Evidence-based learning:** portfolio artefacts, self-assessment and performance tasks document progress across the level.

Unit 1 - Hello! This Is Me

Identity, greetings and first exchanges

Communicative outcomes	Greet and take leave; spell names; ask/give name, age, country, nationality, language, phone/email and basic personal details; use classroom survival phrases.
Grammar & functions	Verb be (affirmative/negative/questions); subject pronouns; possessive adjectives; a/an; basic Wh- questions; this/that; contractions; can I...? for classroom requests.
Vocabulary	Alphabet; numbers 0-100; countries and nationalities; languages; school objects; titles and greetings; personal information.
Pronunciation	Alphabet names; /h/ in hello/house; clear final consonants; contractions with be; rising/falling intonation in basic questions.
Integrated skills	Read a registration form; listen for names/numbers; complete a profile; conduct a short interview; mediate a classmate's basic information.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Name-and-alphabet speed circles: spell names and check understanding.
- Information-gap identity cards: ask only in English to complete missing details.
- "Find someone who..." with countries, languages and ages.
- Listening grid for names, phone numbers and classroom instructions.
- Mini role-play: new student meets teacher and classmates.

Authentic performance task

"My English Profile": students create a one-page profile and deliver a 45-60 second introduction, then answer two predictable questions.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Visual word bank; question cards; model audio; sentence frames ("My name is...", "I'm from..."); paired rehearsal.
Expected level	Independent profile and short interaction with occasional reference to notes.
Extension	Add interests, family details and spontaneous follow-up questions; introduce a partner from memory.

Evidence of learning

- I can introduce myself and spell my name.
- I can ask and answer basic personal questions.
- I can understand common classroom instructions.
- I can write simple personal information accurately.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 2 - Family, Friends and People

Describe familiar people and relationships

Communicative outcomes	Identify family members; describe basic appearance and personality; say who something belongs to; express simple likes/dislikes.
Grammar & functions	Have/has got or have/has; possessive 's; possessive adjectives; adjective order at basic level; plural nouns; these/those; like/love/don't like + noun/-ing.
Vocabulary	Family; relationships; basic appearance; personality adjectives; colours; clothes; pets; common possessions.
Pronunciation	Plural -s endings /s, z, ɪz/ (awareness); /v/ in very/five; final sounds in age/old/tall; word stress in nationality and personality words.
Integrated skills	Read short profiles; listen to descriptions and identify people; write 5-7 linked sentences; describe a photo; ask follow-up questions.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Family-tree puzzle using information-gap clues.
- "Who is it?" photo description game.
- Adjective sorting: appearance vs personality, positive vs neutral.
- Class survey on pets, siblings and favourite activities.
- Gallery walk with sticky-note questions in English.

Authentic performance task

"People in My World": visual gallery with 3-4 people and a one-minute oral description using family vocabulary, have/has and adjectives.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Picture dictionary, adjective bank, colour coding for he/she/they, model descriptions and guided writing frame.
Expected level	6-8 clear sentences plus short oral description and one question-answer exchange.
Extension	Compare two people, add reasons for preferences and use a wider range of adjectives without a script.

Evidence of learning

- I can name close family members and relationships.
- I can describe a person with simple adjectives.
- I can say what people have and what they like.
- I can understand a short personal profile.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 3 - My Day and My School

Routines, time and everyday habits

Communicative outcomes	Tell the time; sequence a normal day; talk about school subjects and routines; ask about frequency; understand a simple timetable.
Grammar & functions	Present simple; do/does questions; third-person -s; adverbs of frequency; prepositions of time in/on/at; sequence markers first/then/after that/finally.
Vocabulary	Daily routines; school subjects; classroom actions; days/months; times; meals; homework; frequency expressions.
Pronunciation	Third-person -s endings; contrast thirteen/thirty and similar numbers; sentence stress in time expressions; rhythm in routine chunks.
Integrated skills	Listen to a daily routine; read a timetable; ask classmates about habits; write a sequenced paragraph; report one partner's routine.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Human clock and time bingo.
- Routine picture sequencing with oral retelling.
- Pair interview: "What time do you...?" and "How often...?"
- Timetable problem-solving: find common free time.
- Mini dictation focusing on times, days and routine verbs.

Authentic performance task

"A Day in My Life": 8-step visual timeline or 60-90 second audio diary with times, routines and two frequency expressions.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Routine icons, time template, verb bank, model paragraph and pre-recording rehearsal.
Expected level	Sequenced production with present simple and understandable third-person/verb endings.
Extension	Compare weekday/weekend routines and report a classmate's routine using he/she accurately.

Evidence of learning

- I can tell the time and understand a simple timetable.
- I can describe my daily routine in order.
- I can ask about another person's habits.
- I can use frequency words in simple sentences.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 4 - Home, Town and Directions

Locate, describe and move through familiar places

Communicative outcomes	Name rooms and town places; describe where things are; say what exists; ask/give simple directions; make basic requests in public places.
Grammar & functions	There is/there are; some/any; prepositions of place; imperatives; can/could I...? (formulaic politeness); where is/are...?; basic conjunctions and/but/because.
Vocabulary	Rooms, furniture, public places, shops, street features, directions, transport basics, location phrases.
Pronunciation	/θ/ and /ð/ awareness in three/this; linking in "turn_left / go_on"; stress on key direction words; polite rising intonation.
Integrated skills	Read signs/maps; follow short oral directions; describe a room; role-play asking for help; mediate a route on a map.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- "Spot the difference" room descriptions.
- Map treasure hunt with direction clues.
- Build-a-town collaborative poster.
- Role-play: visitor and local resident.
- Listening task: follow a route and mark the destination.

Authentic performance task

"Welcome to Our Town": groups create a map with at least eight locations; each student gives one route and answers a visitor question.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Arrow cards, labelled map, sentence starters, gesture-supported modelling and repeated audio.
Expected level	Give a 4-6 step route using basic imperatives and place phrases.
Extension	Add landmarks, transport options and an alternative route; improvise when a road is "closed".

Evidence of learning

- I can describe where objects and places are.
- I can ask for and give simple directions.
- I can understand common signs and map labels.
- I can use there is/there are in a familiar description.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 5 - Food, Shopping and Free Time

Make choices, buy things and talk about interests

Communicative outcomes	Order food/drinks; ask prices; express quantity and preference; talk about hobbies and abilities; accept/refuse a simple invitation.
Grammar & functions	Countable/uncountable nouns (basic); some/any; much/many at recognition level; would like; can/can't; like + -ing; how much/how many; object pronouns basics.
Vocabulary	Food and drinks; meals; containers; prices and money; clothes/basic shopping; hobbies; days and free-time activities.
Pronunciation	Schwa awareness in unstressed syllables; polite intonation in "I'd like..."; /ɪ/ vs /i:/ awareness (ship/sheep type contrast); clear prices.
Integrated skills	Read a menu/price list; listen to an order; role-play customer/server; write a short invitation; conduct a preference survey.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Menu matching and "build a meal" challenge.
- Class café with rotating roles.
- Price listening race and shopping list task.
- Hobby mime and "Can you...?" survey.
- Invitation cards: accept, refuse and suggest another time.

Authentic performance task

"English Café / Market": students complete a realistic customer-service exchange using prices, quantities, preferences and polite formulae.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Picture menus, dialogue strips, price cards, rehearsal stations and role cards with key expressions.
Expected level	Complete a 6-8 turn service dialogue and write a short related message.
Extension	Handle an unavailable item, ask follow-up questions and make a recommendation.

Evidence of learning

- I can order food or buy a simple item politely.
- I can ask and understand basic prices and quantities.
- I can talk about hobbies and abilities.
- I can write a short invitation or reply.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 6 - Weather, Plans and My English World

Connect the present with simple future plans and recent past

Communicative outcomes	Describe weather; say what is happening now; express a near-future plan; refer to a simple past situation using was/were and a small set of common past verbs.
Grammar & functions	Present continuous; be going to; review present simple; was/were; introduction to regular past -ed and selected high-frequency irregulars (went, had, saw); basic time markers yesterday/tomorrow/last/next.
Vocabulary	Weather, seasons, clothing for weather, weekend plans, holidays, countries/cities, simple travel and memory words.
Pronunciation	-ed endings awareness; contractions in present continuous/going to; stress on time words; natural chunking in short presentations.
Integrated skills	Understand a simple forecast; read a short travel postcard; describe a photo; write weekend plans; record a short "yesterday-today-tomorrow" message.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Weather forecast matching.
- What are they doing? picture race.
- Weekend planning in pairs using a simple calendar.
- Postcard jigsaw: place, weather, activity, opinion.
- A1 portfolio review and "best work" selection.

Authentic performance task

"My English-Speaking World Passport": identity page, family/friends page, routine, town map, café dialogue evidence and a final 90-second presentation about past/present/future.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Portfolio checklist, model forecast/postcard, verb cards, sentence frames and teacher conferencing.
Expected level	Combine familiar A1 language across several topics with understandable delivery.
Extension	Add reasons, comparisons and spontaneous questions about travel or plans.

Evidence of learning

- I can describe basic weather and current actions.
- I can say what I am going to do soon.
- I can refer to a simple past event with familiar verbs.
- I can combine A1 skills in a short presentation.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Integrative project and assessment

My English-Speaking World Passport

1. Project brief

Students assemble a personal portfolio that proves they can use English in immediate, familiar situations. The product combines identity, family, routine, local navigation, a service encounter and a short past-present-future reflection.

2. Project stages

1. Select or improve one artefact from each unit.
2. Create a visual passport with clear sections and key vocabulary.
3. Record one listening/speaking evidence sample.
4. Rehearse a 90-second presentation using note cards only.
5. Complete a peer checklist and revise one section.
6. Present the passport and answer two simple questions.

3. Assessment architecture

Assessment moment	Evidence
Diagnostic	Alphabet/numbers, recognition of familiar vocabulary, simple self-introduction and short writing sample.
Formative	Exit tickets, mini whiteboards, pronunciation checks, pair role-plays, quick reads/listens and teacher observation.
Performance	Unit tasks such as profile interview, route giving, café exchange and timeline presentation.
Summative	Integrated task covering a short listening/reading plus personal writing and a brief oral interaction.
Portfolio	Six unit artefacts, one corrected draft, one audio/video sample, self-assessment and final passport.

4. Common performance rubric

Criterion	Observable evidence
Task achievement	Completes the communicative purpose and responds to all essential parts of the task.
Range & accuracy	Uses level-appropriate grammar and vocabulary with errors that do not compromise the intended message.
Coherence	Organises ideas with sequencing and linking appropriate to the level and genre.
Interaction / mediation	Responds, clarifies, reformulates, supports turn-taking and/or relays information appropriately.
Pronunciation / delivery	Speaks intelligibly, using progressively appropriate stress, rhythm and intonation.

Implementation guide

Resources, differentiation, routines and exit indicators

1. Recommended classroom resources

- Learner portfolio: diagnostic sample, drafts, corrected productions, recordings, project evidence and self-assessment.
- Dictionaries: visual/bilingual support at lower levels; increasingly monolingual, collocation and learner dictionaries from B1 upward.
- Coursebook: any institution-approved CEFR-aligned English coursebook; exact page numbers must be mapped after the school selects its edition.
- Worksheets: information gaps, reading/listening organisers, pronunciation grids, peer-feedback checklists, writing frames and reflection sheets.
- Authentic input: menus, maps, notices, websites, podcasts, interviews, short articles, videos and literature adapted to age and level.

2. Lesson routine

Phase	Pedagogical use
Opening	Activate prior knowledge, retrieve previously learned language and connect it explicitly to the lesson purpose.
Input	Notice meaning and form through a short text, audio, image, model dialogue or teacher demonstration.
Guided practice	Rehearse the target language with scaffolds, controlled interaction and pronunciation focus.
Main task	Students use the language to solve a problem, exchange information, create a product or communicate a real message.
Reflection & closure	Students complete an observable "I can..." check, submit an exit ticket or record one piece of evidence in the portfolio.

3. Differentiation model

Pathway	Examples
Support	Visuals, word banks, sentence stems, chunked input, slower audio, guided notes, rehearsal time, peer support and reduced output load.
Core	Independent completion of the expected communicative task using authorised resources and standard time.
Extension	Less scaffolding, wider vocabulary, extra constraints, spontaneous follow-up questions, source comparison, mediation or leadership roles.

4. Exit indicators - Level A1

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| ☐ I can introduce myself and exchange basic personal details. | ☐ I can understand familiar words and simple classroom instructions. |
| ☐ I can describe my family, routine and familiar places. | ☐ I can ask for basic information and clarification. |
| ☐ I can write a short message, form or simple description. | ☐ I can order or buy something using polite formulae. |
| ☐ I can talk about simple plans and a familiar past event. | ☐ I can speak intelligibly enough to be understood in predictable situations. |

A1 principle: confidence first - frequent recycling, visible success and meaningful communication build the foundation for independence.